



Liszt at the age of 14
Courtesy "The Musical Quarterly"

Franz Liszt, born in Raiding, Hungary, was a very delicate and sickly boy until he reached the age of six. Then, one day, while his father was playing a *Concerto* on the piano, little Franz came up beside him and implored him to repeat the last movement over and over again. "What would you like to be when you grow up?" asked his father, lighting his pipe. "That man there!" said the boy pointing to a picture of Beethoven. The next day his father began to give him lessons. Franz spent hours practising the scales and made such rapid progress that he played in a concert by the time he was nine years old. The performance was so brilliant that everybody wanted to meet him and some of the nobles present raised funds to send him to Vienna for study with Czerny. Later, "little Liszt" enjoyed a greater triumph for, when Beethoven heard him play, he was amazed by Franz's wonderful technique that he went to the stage, grasped the child, and kissed him on the forehead.

Because the little village of Raiding was rather isolated, it became a camping place for wandering gypsies, who, as they arrived in their wagons, would pitch their tents in the square. At night, amid the blaze of great bonfires, the men with violins and cymbals and the girls in brilliant coloured dresses, ear-rings, and necklaces, would dance and sing the rugged folk-tunes of Romany. Little Franz would drink in these weirdly abrupt rhythms and melodies which later became so evident in his famous *Hungarian Rhapsodies*.

Theme from Liebesträume No. 3

A Dream of Love

Andante Liszt (1811-1886)

First system of musical notation, featuring a treble and bass staff. The treble staff contains a melodic line with eighth and sixteenth notes, including a triplet of eighth notes. The bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment with chords and single notes. A dynamic marking of *mp* (mezzo-piano) is present in the third measure. Fingering numbers (1, 2, 3, 4, 5) are indicated for various notes.

Second system of musical notation, continuing the piece. The treble staff features a melodic line with a triplet of eighth notes. The bass staff has a steady accompaniment. A dynamic marking of *poco a poco cresc.* (poco a poco crescendo) is written across the first two measures. Fingering numbers are present throughout.

Third system of musical notation, showing a change in dynamics and tempo. The treble staff has a melodic line with a triplet of eighth notes. The bass staff has a steady accompaniment. Dynamic markings include *f rit.* (forte ritardando), *mp* (mezzo-piano), and *a tempo*. A dashed line indicates a transition from *mp* to *a tempo*. Fingering numbers are present throughout.

Fourth system of musical notation, concluding the piece. The treble staff features a melodic line with a triplet of eighth notes. The bass staff has a steady accompaniment. Dynamic markings include *pp* (pianissimo) and *poco rit.* (poco ritardando). Fingering numbers are present throughout.